

educations of our offspring.

- ◆ About two-thirds of us work between forty-five and fifty-five hours per week.

- ◆ We are fastidious investors. On average, we invest nearly 20 percent of our household realized income each year. Most of us invest at least 15 percent. Seventy-nine percent of us have at least one account with a brokerage company. But we make our own investment decisions.

- ◆ We hold nearly 20 percent of our household's wealth in transaction securities such as publicly traded stocks and mutual funds. But we rarely sell our equity investments. We hold even more in our pension plans. On average, 21 percent of our household's wealth is in our private businesses.

- ◆ As a group, we feel that our daughters are financially handicapped in comparison to our sons. Men seem to make much more money even within the same occupational categories. That is why most of us would not hesitate to share some of our wealth with our daughters. Our sons, and men in general, have the deck of economic cards stacked in their favor. They should not need subsidies from their parents.

- ◆ What would be the ideal occupations for our sons and daughters? There are about 3.5 millionaire households like ours. Our numbers are growing much faster than the general population. Our kids should consider providing affluent people with some valuable service. Overall, our most trusted financial advisors are our accountants. Our attorneys are also very important. So we recommend accounting and law to our children. Tax advisors and estate-planning experts will be in big demand over the next fifteen years.

- ◆ I am a tightwad. That's one of the main reasons I completed a long questionnaire for a crispy \$1 bill. Why else would I spend two or three hours being personally interviewed by these authors? They paid me \$100, \$200, or \$250. Oh, they made me another offer—to donate in my name the money I earned for my interview to my favorite charity. But I told them, "I am my favorite charity."